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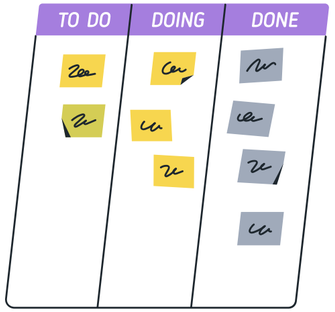
ALWAYS BUSY, NEVER PRODUCTIVE



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HOW WAS YOUR DAY?



Work in pairs or small groups. Look at the scale. Which number is true for you today? Choose 1, 2, 3, 4 or 5.
Discuss the questions below with your partner or group.

1	2	3	4	5
Very tired. I did a lot but nothing important.	I was busy all day but nothing feels finished.	OK. I did some things. Not bad, not great.	Good. I did some things that really mattered.	I did exactly what I needed to do today.

Have you finished everything on your to-do list today?

Have you done anything today that you're happy about?

Have you ever had a day where you were busy but did nothing important?

Is "busy" the same as "good"? Have you changed your mind about this recently?

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CONVINCE ME

Work in pairs or small groups. Look at the photos below. Each student chooses one person. You think your person had a more productive day. Talk to your partner and try to convince them. In the end, decide together: who was more productive and why?









Giving your opinion:

- *I think...*
- *I feel like...*
- *For me,...*
- *To be honest,...*
- *I guess...*



Comparing:

- *I think this one is better because...*
- *This person is more productive because...*
- *This one didn't really...*
- *This one actually...*

Disagreeing:

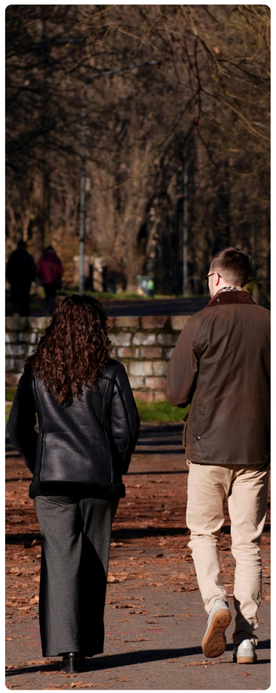
- *I'm not sure about that.*
- *I see your point, but...*
- *Yeah, but...*
- *I don't really agree.*

Agreeing:

- *I agree.*
- *That's a good point.*
- *Exactly.*









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DID YOUR DAY REALLY MATTER?

Work in pairs. Read the posts and comments. Pay attention to the words and phrases in bold. Which post can you relate to? Share your opinion with your partner or group.



@sarah.c

Okay so today I've **got through** 47 emails, attended 5 meetings, and answered every message. I am so **exhausted** right now.

But was it actually a productive day?
I really don't know.

Nothing on my real to-do list has moved forward. I feel like I was just **spinning my wheels** all day.

34 ♥ 87 12



@mike.k

This is me every Monday. Being busy and being effective are not the same thing!



@r.lopez

Emails don't count as **achievements**. Change my mind.



@dan.thinks

Hot take: most "busy" people are just really good at avoiding one hard task that would actually **make a difference**.

We fill our days with small tasks because they feel safe.

Real **productivity** is uncomfortable.
It means saying no to easy things and focusing on what really matters.

91 ♥ 213 55



@anna.p

I totally agree. Sometimes you look busy, but you're just **putting off** important things.



@j.b

Maybe... but some people have a lot to do. It's not always easy to focus.



@n.writes

My new rule: at the end of the day I ask myself — "What have I actually achieved?"

Not what I've done, not how many tasks I've **ticked off**. What really moved forward?

If I can't answer that, the day was busy but not really useful.

Activity is not the same as achievement.

62 ♥ 341 88



@t.green

Saving this. I need to stop thinking that being busy means making progress.



@k.m

But rest is also important! Not every day has to be about achievement.

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USEFUL VOCABULARY

Look at the parts of sentences from the previous slide and choose the correct meaning of the words and phrases in bold.

1. …today I've **got through** 47 emails…
   - a) finished dealing with something difficult or a lot of work
   - b) started doing something new

2. I am so **exhausted** right now.
   - a) very tired and without energy
   - b) a bit bored or not interested

3. I feel like I was just **spinning my wheels** all day.
   - a) working very fast and getting a lot done
   - b) wasting time doing things that are not important

4. Emails don't count as **achievements**.
   - a) something small and not important you do every day
   - b) something good that you have done successfully

5. …one hard task that would actually **make a difference**.
   - a) have an important effect on something
   - b) stop doing something for a short time

6. …you're actually **putting off** important things.
   - a) finishing something very quickly
   - b) deciding to do something later instead of now

7. Real **productivity** is uncomfortable.
   - a) the ability to do useful work and get good results
   - b) doing many small things which are not important

8. Not what I've done, not how many tasks I've **ticked off**.
   - a) marked tasks as finished on a list
   - b) started new and important tasks



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LET'S PRACTISE

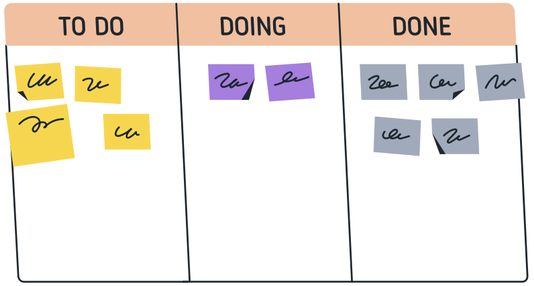
1. Choose the correct word or phrase from the box to complete each sentence.

1. After a long day at work, Anna felt completely **exhausted / productive.** She went straight to bed.
2. Tom didn't want to write that difficult email, so he **put it off / ticked it off** until the next day.
3. I've **got through / made a difference** with a lot of emails today, but nothing important is finished.
4. Maria had a busy day but she didn't do anything important. She felt like she was just **ticking off / spinning her wheels**.
5. Jake didn't want to call his client, but he did it. After the call he felt really good. For him, it was a real **achievement / productivity**.
6. Lisa had a very busy week. On Friday she finally sat down and wrote a proper to-do list. It really **put off / made a difference** — she knew exactly what to do on Monday.
7. After work yesterday, Jack looked at his list and **put off / ticked off** everything he did that day.
8. Good **productivity / achievement** means you do the right tasks — not just a lot of tasks.

2. Match the sentence halves to make complete and logical sentences.

1. At 6pm I felt completely exhausted — …
2. I keep putting off that phone call to the landlord …
3. We've got through the whole agenda …
4. Yesterday she spent the whole morning spinning her wheels — …
5. I've finally achieved something at work — …
6. That honest chat with my sister has really made a difference — …
7. I love ticking things off my list — …

____ a) … it makes me feel like the day wasn't wasted.
____ b) … I feel so much better now.
____ c) … it was a very long day and my eyes were tired after working at the computer.
____ d) … because I don't know what to say about the heating.
____ e) … I've worked on this project for three months.
____ f) … but the team hasn't finished anything important.
____ g) … she reorganised her desk three times and answered no emails.



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CAN YOU RELATE?

Complete the sentences with the correct words and phrases from the previous slide. Mind the grammar.
For each statement, rate how much you can relate (1 = not at all, 5 = very much). After rating, explain your choice.



I like to **t**_____ tasks **o**_____ on a list. It makes me feel good, even if the tasks are small.	1	2	3	4	5
When I do one thing that really **m**_____ ___**d**_____, I feel better than after a whole busy day.	1	2	3	4	5
For me, real **p**_____ means I do the right things — not just a lot of things.	1	2	3	4	5
I sometimes **p**_____ difficult tasks **o**_____ because I don't want to start them.	1	2	3	4	5
Answering emails or calls all day long doesn't feel like a real **a**_____ to me.	1	2	3	4	5
I can **g**_____ **t**_____a lot of work and still feel like I did nothing important.	1	2	3	4	5
At the end of a busy day, I often feel completely **e**_____, but I haven't done anything really important.	1	2	3	4	5
Some days I feel like I'm just **s**_____ **m**_____ **w**_____. I'm busy, but nothing changes.	1	2	3	4	5

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THE HONEST LIST

Optional activity

Work in pairs or small groups. Think about your day or week. Write one thing in each box. Then share with your partner or group.

Something I got through

Something you did a lot of — but maybe wasn't that important.

_____

_____

_____

A real achievement

One thing this week that actually has made a difference.

_____

_____

_____



Something I've been putting off

Something important you keep not doing. Be honest.

_____

_____

_____

A day I was spinning my wheels

A day when you were busy but nothing really moved forward.

_____

_____

_____

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DID IT COUNT?

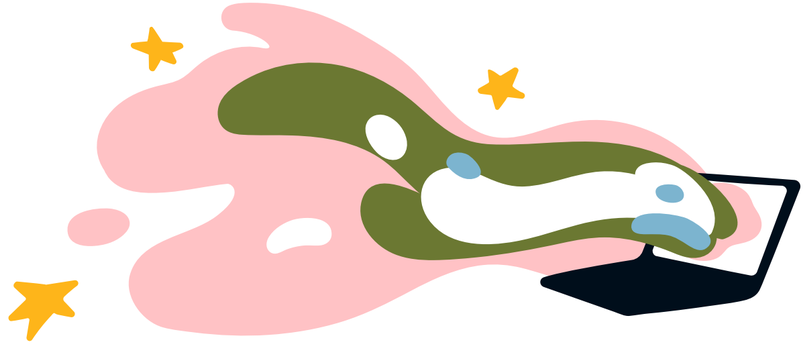


PLAY NOW

Work in pairs or small groups. Click on the card to get a random to-do list.

Read the tasks and decide – was this a productive day?

Give it a rating and explain your opinion.



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HOT TAKES

Optional activity

Work in pairs or small groups. Read the hot takes below — these are strong opinions about productivity and busy days. Tick "agree" or "disagree" for each one. Then write your own hot take. Share your opinions and react to each other using the phrases below.

If you feel exhausted at the end of the day, it is a productive day. Full stop.

Most people put off the important things and call it a "busy day."

One hour of real work makes more of a difference than a whole day of emails and meetings.



Giving your opinion:

- *I think...*
- *For me...*
- *In my opinion...*
- *To be honest...*

Disagreeing:

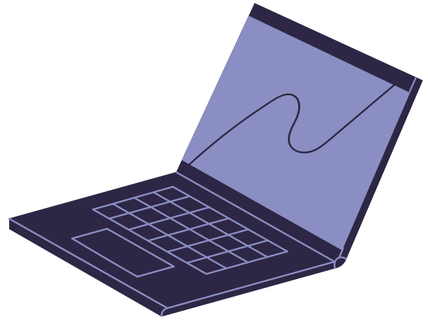
- *I don't really agree because...*
- *I'm not sure about that.*
- *Yes, but I think...*
- *For me it's different because...*

Agreeing:

- *I totally agree because...*
- *That's so true!*
- *Exactly – for example...*
- *Yes, and I think...*

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EXTRA TASK



Read the three messages below. Write a reply to each one. Use at least one word or phrase from the lesson in every reply. Write 2–4 sentences for each reply.

I've just got home. I've had a really long day — meetings, calls, lots of messages. I feel so tired. But I'm not sure I've done anything important today. Have that ever happened to you too?

I need to write an important email to my boss. I've had it on my list since Monday and today is Thursday. Every day I do other things instead. Why is it so hard to just start?

Great news — I've finally finished my big work project! It has taken three months. I'm really happy about it. How is your week? Have you done anything you're proud of?

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EXTRA TASKS

1. Complete each sentence with the correct word or phrase from the lesson. Mind the grammar.



1. I had a long day at work yesterday. I got through lots of emails but I felt completely _____ at the end.
2. Tom has a big presentation tomorrow but he has _____ all week. He hasn't started yet.
3. We've had a long meeting today but it hasn't really _____ . Everything is still the same.
4. She finally finished her online course last month. It was a real _____ for her.
5. I feel like I've been _____ all week. I'm very busy but nothing is finished.
6. Good _____ means you do the right things, not just a lot of things.
7. He _____ all the tasks on his list before lunchtime and felt really good about it.
8. I've finally cleaned my whole flat. I've _____ so much today — I feel great.

2. Write about the most unproductive day you can imagine — or a real one! Be funny, dramatic, or painfully honest. The more ridiculous the better.

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EXTRA TASK

[Open in Canva and make a copy]

Create a mood board that shows what your perfect productive day looks like – the feeling, the place, the tasks, and the result. Use images, colours, objects, or words to create the right atmosphere.



Think about:

- the feeling
- the place
- the one important task
- the result

What to add to you mood board:

- Photos or images that show the mood or atmosphere of your day.
- Colours that feel right – calm, energetic, focused.
- Objects or symbols connected to your productive day.

Be ready to show your mood board and say two or three sentences about it. Tell your partner: what does your productive day look like – and how is it different from your real day?



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QUIZLET



Quizlet

Revise the words for the next lesson. Use this Quizlet set. You can also play different games to practise or even test yourself in the Quizlet app or on the site.

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THANK YOU!



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